



The X7 Pro runs POCO's HyperOS 2, based on Android 15, offering an intuitive user experience. However, it isn't free from bloatware. The pre-installed apps can be annoying, especially for users who prefer a cleaner interface. On the brighter side, HyperOS introduces useful customisations, including enhanced gestures and gaming-centric features. POCO promises three years of Android updates and four years of security patches, ensuring the device remains relevant for years to come.

Whether you're a gamer, a heavy multitasker, or someone who just needs a phone that doesn't lag during everyday tasks, the X7 Pro performs admirably across the board. However, the software experience, while functional, could benefit from fewer pre-loaded apps.

CAMERA

The camera setup on the POCO X7 Pro is a mixed bag. The dual rear camera system includes a 50MP Sony LYT primary sensor with OIS and an 8MP ultra-wide sensor. The main camera performs well in daylight conditions, capturing sharp images with vibrant colours and decent dynamic range. Portrait mode

delivers pleasing bokeh effects, although edge detection isn't always perfect.

The ultra-wide sensor offers a broader perspective but suffers from noticeable distortion and reduced detail at the edges. Low-light photography is serviceable, but the absence of a dedicated telephoto lens limits its versatility in certain scenarios. Even with night mode, photos can appear grainy and lose out on finer details.

On the front, the 20MP selfie camera is capable of producing sharp and bright selfies in good lighting conditions. Overall, while the cameras are decent, they are not the strongest suit of the X7 Pro.

BATTERY LIFE

The POCO X7 Pro houses a massive 6,550mAh silicon-carbon battery, attempting to set a new benchmark for smartphones in this segment. However, it falls short in doing so. In the PCMark Work Battery Test, the phone only lasted for 12 hours and 34 minutes, which is lacklustre endurance for a massive 6,550mAh battery. I honestly expected more, and I hope POCO can improve endurance by tweaking the software optimisation in future OTA updates.

The device supports 90W fast charging, which is a game-changer for users with a hectic schedule. In just 48 minutes, the phone charges from 0 to 100%, eliminating the need for extended downtime.

VERDICT

The POCO X7 Pro is a strong contender in the mid-range smartphone segment, offering an excellent mix of performance, build quality, and display prowess. It caters to gamers and those who prioritize a vibrant display and a modern design. Its vegan leather finish, IP68 certification, and high-brightness AMOLED display are commendable.

However, the cameras, while decent, leave room for improvement, especially in low-light scenarios. Additionally, the software could use refinement, with fewer pre-installed apps to enhance the overall user experience. The battery life is also disappointing given this phone is largely marketed towards gamers who would expect longer endurance. However, fast charging does redeem it a bit in this regard.

Still, if you're looking for a reliable, feature-packed phone that excels in performance and battery life, the POCO X7 Pro is worth considering. For camera enthusiasts or those seeking a more polished software experience, alternative options might be more suitable. Nonetheless, the POCO X7 Pro offers excellent value for money, cementing its place as one of the most powerful mid-range smartphones currently available.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Elite | OS: Android 15, OxygenOS 15 | RAM: 12/16/24 GB | Storage: 256 GB/512 GB/1 TB | IP Rating: IP68/IP69 | Display: 6.82 LTPO 4.1 AMOLED, 1440 x 3168 pixels | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Display protection: Ceramic Guard | Cameras: 50 MP + 50 MP + 50 MP | Selfie Camera: 32 MP | Battery: 6,000 mAh | Charging: 100 W wired, 50 W wireless, 10 W reverse wireless

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